

HOUSE No. 3632

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Antonio F. D. Cabral

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act to promote commuter rail ridership.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Antonio F. D. Cabral</i>	<i>13th Bristol</i>	<i>1/17/2025</i>
<i>Vanna Howard</i>	<i>17th Middlesex</i>	<i>1/30/2025</i>
<i>Rodney M. Elliott</i>	<i>16th Middlesex</i>	<i>2/4/2025</i>
<i>Christopher Hendricks</i>	<i>11th Bristol</i>	<i>2/5/2025</i>
<i>James B. Eldridge</i>	<i>Middlesex and Worcester</i>	<i>2/12/2025</i>
<i>Mary S. Keefe</i>	<i>15th Worcester</i>	<i>3/5/2025</i>
<i>Natalie M. Higgins</i>	<i>4th Worcester</i>	<i>3/18/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 3632

By Representative Cabral of New Bedford, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 3632) of Antonio F. D. Cabral and others relative to commuter rail service fares. Transportation.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act to promote commuter rail ridership.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Chapter 161A of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022 Official Edition, is hereby
2 amended by inserting after Section 52 the following new section:-

3 Section 53. Commuter rail service fares

4 Section 1. The General Manager of the Metropolitan Boston Transit Agency (“MBTA”)
5 shall create fare structure for the MBTA commuter rail designed to increase ridership among
6 residents of transit-oriented areas, including but not limited to the consideration of the following
7 fare structure:

8 A \$10 all-inclusive weekday fare comparable to the existing \$10 weekend and holiday
9 fare;

10 One-way fares not to surpass three times the regular subway fare;

11 Monthly passes priced for hybrid workers, for example those who commute three days
12 per week rather than five days per week;

13 Discounts for purchasing multiple rides, for example a 10- or 12-pack;

14 Reducing the number of commuter rail zones and simplifying overall fare pricing;

15 Off-setting ticket price reductions with increased parking rates.

16 Section 2. Within 12 months of enactment, the General Manager of the MBTA shall
17 submit recommendations for these and other possibilities to the Governor and the Legislature,
18 along with estimates for the impact on ridership.

19 Section 3. Within 24 months of enactment, the General Manager of the MBTA shall
20 execute pilot programs to test the implementation and impact on commuter rail ridership based
21 on the recommendations in section 1.